

Digital English

Techno talk is gradually supplanting British English as the standard, and gaming rules in Digit

Writing and working for a magazine that brings you the very latest in the digital world has a very interesting side effect. It changes the way you think and talk.

Here are some samples of typical 'Digit' talk:

Sample 1: The elevator is under repair. On realising that the lift would be unavailable, a Digster very helpfully informs her colleagues that the lift is 'offline'.

Sample 2: Another Digster has a tough time explaining what she wants to the dressmaker. Because all that she can think of saying is, "*Mujhe yeh dress isi format mein chahiye*".

Sample 3: Hunger pangs strike and people are in a mood for a pizza party. But there's a snag. The guy taking the order has no clue what you mean when you ask, "Do I have to configure my own pizza? Don't you guys have any default options?"

The more initiated among us tend to go a step further. The things that get them excited would puzzle most others. Don't believe us? Here's an exchange we overheard:

"Hey! Look at this!"

"What?"

"This event added itself to my Alerts list. I got an e-mail about it but I didn't add it."

"How does it do that?"

"I dunno, but it seems to work like an Outlook worm."

"What!?!? Gimme, Gimme, I want to have a look at the source code."

Surrounded as we are by technology and techno talk, we sometimes tend to forget how things work in a lesser world. The other day someone was looking desperately for Varun in the Test Centre. Now most of the communication happens over MSN, and this is what we recorded:

"Damn, I need to find Varun!"

"Must be at his desk."

"Nope he's not online on MSN."

"Have you tried the phone?"

"Oops."

Not to mention this other incidence when a PR guy wanted to send some product information to one of our writers. "Ok," says the writer, "just e-mail it over to me."

"Can't I send it to you by fax?" asks the PR person. "Er...I'm not sure that I have a viewer for that." (Go figure!)

So where does this rapid takeover of British English by digital English leave us? One thing is definite, we are very likely candidates for alternate careers. We heard there are courses in US universities that examine how 'talking' is gradually turning into 'techtalking'. Maybe we can apply to these schools for posts as visiting faculty. Any takers? 

Go Slow, People Hard at Play

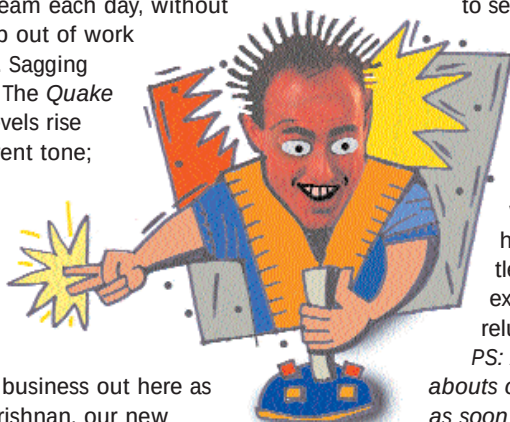
From 6 pm, the countdown begins. Everybody at Digit keeps sneaking a look at the clock, waiting for the magic hour of 6.30 pm for that's game time! That's the appointed hour when avid gamers in the Digit team each day, without fail, come hell or high water, slip out of work mode and slide into play mode. Sagging energy levels mysteriously soar. The *Quake* server is switched on, decibel levels rise and the keyboards clack a different tone; we now begin to hear bangs, booms, staccato gun fire and spine chilling cries of "Aaaaaargh, you fragged me", and others to that effect.

Call it an addiction, call it an affliction, call it a passion, call it what you will. *Quake* is serious business out here as newcomers soon realise. Like Krishnan, our new

COO - Content Services, found out when he walked into the Test Center looking for its head honcho, Marco.

Not familiar with the 'tradition', he was a little taken aback to see *Quake* running on all the machines and war cries rending the air. Unable to locate Marco, he came up behind Hatim and gently tapping him on the shoulder, ventured to ask where Marco was. Now absolutely nothing can come between the gamer and the game. With full attention on the game, Hatim dismissed him with a brusque, "He's not here", without taking his eyes off the monitor even for a moment. A little taken aback, Krishnan asked again. Completely exasperated, Hatim looked up, paused, and then reluctantly trooped off in search of Marco.

PS: A big hue and cry was made for the whereabouts of Marco, so that *The Game* could be resumed as soon as possible.



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